

Question 40 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Evaluate a proposed HRD practice that has strong training content but weak linkage with organisational strategy, performance appraisal, and career planning.

Introduction

Evaluate the proposal: strengths, weaknesses, likely results using Kirkpatrick's way of thinking, a verdict, and what to change. Do not reject good teaching quality. Do reject isolation. Strong content means sound objectives inside the classroom, expert trainers, useful material. Weak linkage means the topic may not be what strategy needs, bosses do not put the skill into appraisal, and the course does not count toward any career path.

Detailed points

- 1. Strength — learning inside the room may still happen.** Good pedagogy can produce high participant reaction and some real learning (Kirkpatrick levels 1 and 2). People may understand concepts they did not know. This strength is real and should be kept if the topic can be aligned.
- 2. Weakness — strategy irrelevance.** The organisation may be teaching a fashionable topic while critical capabilities for the next two years are ignored. Opportunity cost: seats and rupees used on the wrong need. As HRD, the practice is then ineffective even if the class is excellent.
- 3. Weakness — appraisal disconnect and failed transfer.** If bosses do not expect or reinforce the new behaviour, employees return to old key result areas. Level 3 (behaviour on the job) fails. Strong content cannot jump this gap alone. This is the most common failure of 'good training'.
- 4. Weakness — career disconnect and weak motivation to apply.** If learning does not count toward growth, only highly self-driven staff will practise. Others treat the course as a break. Development impact stays individual and accidental, not organisational.
- 5. Likely results (evaluation using levels).** Level 1 possibly high. Level 2 mixed to good. Level 3 poor. Level 4 (organisational results) poor. A manager who looks only at smile sheets will wrongly approve the practice.
- 6. Climate signal.** Repeated isolated excellent courses create 'holiday training' cynicism. Trust in HRD falls, which later harms even well-linked programmes.
- 7. Conditional value.** The practice may still help as general education for a few motivated employees. That is not enough to accept it as an organisational HRD practice in its present form.
- 8. Verdict and redesign.** Do not accept as-is. Keep the strong content only after: (a) remapping the topic to strategy and TNA, (b) inserting pre- and post-appraisal goals and boss coaching, (c) placing the programme on competency and career maps, (d) evaluating behaviour and results, not only reaction. Then the same content can become effective HRD.

Conclusion. *Judgement: content quality is necessary but not sufficient. Without links to strategy, performance appraisal and career planning, the proposal is an expensive learning event, not an HRD practice. Recommend redesign of linkages, not celebration of the trainer alone.*